challenges of land acquisition in the country – the major highlights of the Bill are as follows:

(i) For the first time, resettlement and rehabilitation both have been emphasised on the same footing;

(ii) Scrutiny of all private purchase of land between 2011 and 2013 (there has been a concern among many that the land mafias have grabbed cheap land from the farmers before the proposed Bill has been passed by the Government);

(iii) A provision to enable state legislation on leasing in place of acquisition of land;

(iv) Instead of acquisition, land to be leased to developers, so that the ownership remains with farmers and provides them a regular income – the government to amend the *Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Bill, 2011*, to provide for an enabling provision to states for enacting laws in this regard (leasing of land is a state subject under the Constitution).

Experts, together with the GoI, beleive that once the new Act is implemented, the issue of land acquisition in the country will become more smooth and will be able to avoid the controversies which we saw in the recent times.

Performance of SEZs

As per the *Economic Survey 2012-13*, the performance of SEZs today is as given below –

- Since the Special Economic Zones Act and Rules were notified in February 2006, formal approvals have been granted for setting up of 579 SEZs, of which 384 have been notified.
- Of the total ***employment*** provided to 9,45,990 persons in SEZs as a whole, that to 8,11,286 persons is incremental employment generated after February 2006 when the SEZ Act came into force. This is apart from the million mandays of employment created by the developer for infrastructure activities.
- While in 2010-11, physical ***exports*** from SEZs were worth Rs. 3,15,867.85 crore, in 2011-12 the figure had gone up to Rs.